

THE GOLDEN TRAIN

[The Golden Train]

SCENE 01 INT. FREIGHT TRAIN CAB - DAY

The cab of a MODERN FREIGHT TRAIN. The TRAIN DRIVER, a kind-faced man in a rumpled uniform, hums happily. His lunchbox sits open, a half-eaten sandwich poised in his hand. The vast, empty landscape WHIZZES by outside.

TRAIN DRIVER

*(to himself,
smiling)*

Another beautiful day on the
rails. Nothing quite like it.

Suddenly, a series of ALERT LIGHTS FLASH bright red across the console. The DRIVER blinks, startled. He tries to take a bite of his sandwich, but his hand freezes.

TRAIN DRIVER

*(confused, then
worried)*

What in the world? That's not
right. All systems green, just a
second ago.

The TRAIN WHISTLE BLASTS ON ITS OWN, a piercing shriek.

TRAIN DRIVER

*(yelling over
whistle)*

Hey! Stop that! I didn't touch it!

The controls go HAYWIRE. DIALS SPIN wildly. LEVERS SLAM down and up with a mind of their own. The driver's eyes widen in terror. He clutches the console, trying to wrestle control, but the machine is unresponsive.

TRAIN DRIVER

*(struggling,
desperate)*

It's fighting me! I can't hold it!
This is impossible!

The train RUMBLES, picking up alarming speed. He looks out the window just as a TRACK SWITCH shifts, seemingly on its own, sending the train onto a different route.

TRAIN DRIVER

(horrified)

Oh no! Not the old mountain line!
We're heading straight for a
disaster!

TRAIN DRIVER

*(frantic, into
radio)*

Mayday! Mayday! This is Freight
Train 342! I've lost control!

TRAIN DRIVER

*(panicked, slamming
a button)*

The train is unresponsive! It's
accelerating! Heading towards the
old mountain line!

TRAIN DRIVER

(yelling, eyes wide)

This train carries a highly
valuable cargo! Gold! It's
completely out of control!

The driver slams the radio back onto its hook. He braces himself as the train RATTLES violently, accelerating even faster, heading straight for the looming mountain range. His sandwich falls, forgotten, to the floor. The clock hits 0:45.

SCENE 02 INT. BRAVO'S ROOM / WIDGETEERS LAB - DAY (ACT I - THE SETUP - 0:45 - 2:30)

BRAVO (10), an analytical prodigy, meticulously moves a miniature tank on a complex board game. TANGO (10), a spontaneous inventor, dramatically rolls a pair of dice. A small, SPHERICAL DRONE, PIPPI, hovers impatiently between them, BEEPING. The room is a mix of normal kid stuff and hidden tech.

BRAVO

(to Tango, precise)

Optimal strategy dictates a defensive posture. Your roll determines everything.

TANGO

(grinning, shaking dice)

Defense is boring! I'm going for a surprise attack! Here goes nothing!

Tango's dice roll OFF THE TABLE and hit a REMOTE CONTROL. The nearby TV SCREEN, showing a cartoon, instantly SWITCHES to a "BREAKING NEWS" alert. A serious NEWS ANCHOR appears.

BRAVO

(annoyed, then curious)

Tango! Now look what you've done. Oh, wait. What's this?

NEWS ANCHOR

(somber, on TV)

We interrupt this program for an urgent update. A runaway freight train, reportedly carrying a multi-million-dollar gold shipment, is speeding uncontrollably towards the Whispering Peaks mountain range.

TANGO

(eyes wide, nudging Bravo)

Did you hear that, Bravo? A gold train! That sounds like a big problem!

BRAVO

(thoughtful, tapping chin)

And "uncontrollable" means someone's behind this. This isn't just a malfunction.

TANGO

(excited)

A runaway train with gold? This is even better than our game!

BRAVO

(serious)

This sounds like a job for the Widgeteers. Someone needs our help, Tango.

Bravo and Tango exchange a knowing glance. PiPi BEEPS excitedly, doing a little aerial flip. Tango GRINS.

TANGO

(pumped up)

PiPi agrees! Let's get to the lab, pronto!

Tango presses a HIDDEN BUTTON disguised as a loose floorboard. A section of the floor beneath them SLIDES OPEN to reveal a SLEEK, SHINY SLIDE. They hop in, disappearing down the chute. PiPi zips in after them. They land with a WHOOSH in a HIGH-TECH, CIRCULAR LAB filled with glowing monitors and whirring gadgets. Their everyday clothes are instantly REPLACED by sleek, custom-fitted GADGETEER SUITS. This happens via a quick, dynamic, visual transformation sequence with light effects.

BRAVO

(pulling on his gloves)

Time to switch gears, Tango. Gold heist in progress!

TANGO

(admiring his suit)

And just look at these suits! Always a perfect fit.

BRAVO

(checking a monitor)

Focus, Tango. The train's trajectory suggests a deliberate rerouting.

TANGO

*(grinning, grabbing
a grappling hook)*

Let's roll! Or... fly! PiPi, set
coordinates for the Whispering
Peaks!

PiPi's central EYE GLOWS green, projecting a map onto
a large screen. The boys jump onto two sleek, ADVANCED
HOVER-BIKES that emerge from the floor. PiPi docks
itself onto the back of Tango's bike. They activate
the bikes, which LIFT them rapidly through a SECRET
EXIT in the ceiling, launching them into the sky. The
clock hits 2:30.

**SCENE 03 EXT. MOUNTAIN RANGE / TRAIN TUNNEL ENTRANCE -
DAY (ACT II - THE STRUGGLE - 2:30 - 3:45)**

The hover-bikes SOAR through the air, quickly gaining
on the runaway train. The train, a long metallic
snake, is visible below, spewing smoke as it barrels
towards a DARK MOUNTAIN TUNNEL.

BRAVO

(into comms, urgent)

Driver, confirm your location.
We're approaching rapidly from
above.

Tango activates his comms, a small panel on his wrist.

TANGO

*(into comms,
focused)*

This is Widgeteer Tango to Train
342! Driver, can you hear us?

TRAIN DRIVER

(O.S.)

*(static-filled,
relieved)*

Widgeteers! Thank goodness! It's
completely hacked! Nothing works!

TANGO

(reassuring)

Stay calm, sir! We're here to help. Just hang on.

BRAVO

(analyzing a readout)

We're detecting an advanced digital override. Looks like a professional job.

TANGO

(determined, revving his bike)

Hang tight! We're coming to you! We'll override the system ourselves!

Just as they prepare to descend, the massive freight train SLAMS into the dark mouth of the mountain tunnel. It DISAPPEARS inside, leaving a lingering trail of smoke.

TANGO

(frustrated)

Blast! It went into the tunnel! Now what?

BRAVO

(thinking aloud, tapping his helmet)

It's too risky to follow it in there at that speed. We could crash.

TANGO

(nodding, pointing upwards)

Right! Let's fly over the mountain! We'll intercept it at the other end of the tunnel!

BRAVO

(confirming)

Agreed. It's the most logical course of action.

They quickly veer upwards, soaring over the jagged peaks of the mountain. They reach the tunnel's far exit, hovering, waiting. SECONDS TICK BY. The tunnel entrance remains EMPTY. More seconds. No train. PiPi starts to WHINE impatiently, its little propellers spinning faster.

TANGO

(impatiently)

Any minute now, right? It should be here.

Tango checks his watch, then back to the tunnel. Bravo scans the tunnel entrance, his brow furrowed.

BRAVO

(confused, tapping scanner)

That's impossible. It should have emerged by now. Where could it have gone?

TANGO

(shaking his head, frustrated)

Trains don't just vanish into thin air! This is way too quiet.

BRAVO

(grim)

This isn't good. Something is definitely wrong.

The clock hits 3:45.

SCENE 04 INT. MOUNTAIN TUNNEL - DAY (ACT II - THE STRUGGLE - 3:45 - 5:00)

Tango and Bravo, on their hover-bikes, enter the dark, echoing mountain tunnel. The beams from their bikes' headlights cut through the gloom. They fly slowly, PiPi's scanner BEAM sweeping the walls. They reach the other end of the tunnel. No train. No sign of it.

TANGO

(whispering, to Bravo)

Nothing. It's completely empty.
Are we sure this is the right
tunnel?

BRAVO

*(checking
navigation)*

Absolutely. Our nav system
confirms this is the correct
route.

They power down their bikes, leaving them hovering,
and begin to explore on foot, their footsteps echoing.
The air is cool and damp. PiPi flies ahead, its light
illuminating the path.

TANGO

(uneasy)

This is creepy. It feels like
something out of a mystery novel.

BRAVO

(focused)

Keep your eyes open, Tango.
Anomalies usually leave traces.

Halfway back through the tunnel, PiPi's scanner
SUDDENLY BEEPS LOUDLY. It points its beam at a section
of the tunnel wall.

BRAVO

*(kneeling,
inspecting the
ground)*

PiPi's picking up something. Look,
Tango!

TANGO

(curious)

What is it? A hidden snack bar?

Tango looks down. There's a subtle FORK in the tracks,
nearly indistinguishable from the main line, partially
obscured by debris. Right next to the diverging route,
an OLD, RUSTY SIGN stands lopsidedly. Its faded paint
reads: "END OF TRACK - ABANDONED."

TANGO

*(puzzled, pointing
at the sign)*

"End of Track"? But it looks like
it goes right into that rock wall.

BRAVO

*(inspecting the old
tracks)*

These rails are ancient. Unused
for decades. No train could have
gone this way.

TANGO

(squinting)

Unless it wasn't supposed to go
this way at all.

Bravo pulls out a handheld scanner and aims it at the
rock wall where the tracks appear to end. The scanner
BEEPS and then WHIRS, a confused expression on Bravo's
face. The device's screen displays a strange energy
signature.

BRAVO

(perplexed)

That's odd. My scanner is picking
up... nothing solid.

PiPi, sensing something, flies right up to the "rock
wall" and tries to peck at it. Its beak PHASES RIGHT
THROUGH! PiPi does a surprised little flip.

TANGO

(eyes wide)

Whoa! Did you see that? It just
went through!

BRAVO

(gasps, realizing)

Incredible! It's not a rock wall!
PiPi, your reading was right!

TANGO

*(amazed, reaching
out)*

It's a hologram! A perfectly
rendered, super advanced
holographic wall!

BRAVO

(determined)

They used it to divert the train.
We found the hidden path.

TANGO

(grinning)

Let's see what's on the other
side!

Bravo and Tango, with newfound determination, walk straight through the shimmering, invisible barrier. As they pass, the "rock wall" seems to ripple for a split second before becoming solid again. They find themselves in a SECOND, HIDDEN TUNNEL. The clock hits 5:00.

SCENE 05 INT. HIDDEN TUNNEL - DAY (ACT II - THE STRUGGLE - 5:00 - 6:30)

Inside the forgotten passageway, it's darker, dustier. And there it is: THE MISSING TRAIN. It sits idle on the tracks.

TANGO

*(whispering,
relieved)*

There it is! We found it!

BRAVO

(observing the cab)

And the driver is inside. Looks
like he's tied up.

Tango and Bravo cautiously approach the locomotive. Through the front window, they see the TRAIN DRIVER TIED UP, slumped against the controls. Two bumbling figures, CHURRO (stocky, perpetually hungry) and MUFFIN (tall, gangly, easily confused), are gleefully pushing buttons and pulling levers on the console. They wear matching, slightly-too-tight black uniforms.

CHURRO

*(grinning widely,
pulling a lever)*

Haha! This is way more fun than
driving a regular car! Vroom!

MUFFIN

*(struggling with a
button)*

Is this the "go faster" button,
Churro? Or the "make it stop"
button?

CHURRO

*(scoffing, adjusting
his hat)*

Who cares, Muffin! As long as we
get this gold for Percy! Push it!

MUFFIN

(confused)

But what if we go too fast? I
don't like fast things.

CHURRO

(impatiently)

Just push it! Percy said "speed is
of the essence!"

Muffin blindly PUSHES a large RED BUTTON. With a
sudden JOLT and a loud CHUG, the train lurches
forward, beginning to pick up speed. Churro and Muffin
almost fall over, stumbling into each other, then
laugh.

TANGO

*(yelling, starting
to run)*

They're moving it! Quick, Bravo!
We have to catch them!

BRAVO

(running alongside)

On it! Focus on getting to the
cab. We need to disable their
controls.

The Widgeteers immediately break into a SPRINT, chasing the accelerating train. Tango, lighter and faster, reaches the last wagon first, expertly GRABBING the ladder. Bravo, a moment behind, leaps and SNATCHES the lower rung just in time. PiPi zips up, attaching itself to Tango's back. They begin to nimbly CLIMB to the roof of the train. The train bursts out of the hidden tunnel's far exit, now moving very fast, onto a HIGH STEEL BRIDGE suspended over a DEEP GORGE. Wind WHISTLES past.

CHURRO

(to Muffin, smug)

See, Muffin? Smooth as butter!
Time for our grand exit!

MUFFIN

(nervous)

Are you sure about this, Churro?
It's a very long way down.

Churro and Muffin pop out of the locomotive, see the bridge, and give each other a conspiratorial nod. They strap on BLACK PARACHUTES they conveniently had ready, then LEAP from the train with silly, synchronized yells, floating down into the gorge.

TANGO

*(yelling over the
wind)*

They're getting away! We have to
stop this train!

BRAVO

(frustrated)

Those fools! They've left the
driver in there!

The clock hits 6:30.

**SCENE 06 INT. TRAIN ENGINE / EXT. BRIDGE - DAY (ACT II
- THE STRUGGLE - 6:30 - 7:30)**

Tango and Bravo rush into the locomotive cabin, quickly untying the shaken TRAIN DRIVER. He groggily thanks them.

TRAIN DRIVER

(weakly, grateful)

Oh, thank you, boys. You saved my life. I thought I was a goner.

TANGO

(reassuring)

No problem, sir! Just focus on getting out safely.

Bravo immediately goes to the main control panel, trying to override the hacked system. PiPi's eye glows, projecting a diagram onto the console, guiding Bravo's fingers.

BRAVO

(focused, muttering)

Okay, this hack is sophisticated. But I can bypass it.

TANGO

*(pointing
emphatically)*

Bravo, the emergency stop! Over here!

BRAVO

*(focused on the
screen)*

Almost got it... Just need to disengage the main lock! PiPi, speed it up!

TRAIN DRIVER

(concerned)

We're still moving awfully fast! Are you sure that'll work?

PiPi's BEEPING intensifies. Bravo's fingers FLY across the screen. Just as the train is about to clear the bridge, Bravo's screen flashes GREEN. He gives a triumphant nod to Tango.

BRAVO

(calling out)

Got it, Tango! Now! Pull the lever!

Tango PULLS THE EMERGENCY LEVER DOWN with all his might. The train's wheels GRIND against the rails with a SCREECHING, deafening ROAR. Sparks fly. The whole train SHUDDERS and VIBRATES violently, slowing rapidly, before coming to a violent, final halt just past the bridge. The driver slumps in his seat, exhausted but safe.

TANGO

*(breathing heavily,
triumphant)*

Phew! Mission accomplished! The gold is safe!

BRAVO

*(wiping sweat from
his brow)*

Let's just double-check the manifest. Make sure everything is accounted for.

TANGO

(grinning)

Those two dummies didn't stand a chance against us.

Bravo quickly accesses the train's digital manifest on the console. His confident smile slowly FADES. Tango, watching over his shoulder, sees his expression change. The manifest shows one empty slot where the "Precious Cargo" wagon should be. The last wagon shown is a regular, empty freight car.

TANGO

*(gasping, pointing
at the screen)*

No way! One wagon... The gold wagon! It's gone!

BRAVO

*(frustrated,
slamming the console
lightly)*

They must have detached it in the hidden tunnel! We have to go back!

TANGO

(alarmed)

They tricked us! This was all a diversion!

BRAVO

(determined)

We can still catch them. Let's move!

They race out of the cab, back onto the roof of the halted train. The clock hits 7:30.

SCENE 07 INT. HIDDEN TUNNEL (PART 2) - DAY (ACT III - THE CLIMAX - 7:30 - 9:00)

Tango and Bravo sprint back into the hidden tunnel, the "rock wall" hologram shimmering faintly behind them. PiPi leads the way, its light cutting through the gloom.

TANGO

(urgent)

I hope they haven't gotten far!
That gold is too valuable.

BRAVO

(confident)

They wouldn't be able to move it quickly. We'll catch them.

In the shadows, they spot Churro and Muffin. They are HASTILY transferring heavy GOLD BARS from a detached train wagon into the back of a heavily ARMORED VAN. The gold glints ominously. Churro grunts with effort, almost dropping a bar. Muffin fumbles, nearly tripping.

CHURRO

*(straining, wiping
his brow)*

Ugh! This gold is surprisingly heavy! Percy owes us extra for this!

MUFFIN

*(struggling with a
bar, almost drops)*

it)

I hope there's cake at the lair.
Big cake!

CHURRO

(annoyed)

Less talk, Muffin, more lifting!
We need to load it all!

BRAVO

*(whispering to
Tango, a sly grin)*

I've got a plan. But we need a
distraction. Something big.

TANGO

*(grinning, accepting
the challenge)*

A distraction? My specialty! PiPi,
recon mode! Find something loud!

BRAVO

(nods)

Perfect. I'll handle the swap
while they're occupied.

PiPi zips off into the darker reaches of the tunnel.
It quickly spots an OLD, RUSTY WORKER'S RADIO, long
abandoned, hooked up to a series of ANCIENT PUBLIC
ADDRESS SPEAKERS along the cave walls. PiPi's eye
GLOWS as it HACKS into the system. Suddenly, an
INCREDIBLY LOUD, OBNOXIOUS LOOP of screeching POLKA
MUSIC mixed with grating STATIC BLASTS from the
speakers, echoing maddeningly off the cave walls. It's
truly horrendous.

CHURRO

*(clutching his ears,
enraged)*

Aaargh! My ears! What IS that
horrible noise?!

MUFFIN

*(wincing, dropping a
gold bar with a
CLANG)*

It sounds like... a dying
accordion fighting a broken radio!
Make it stop!

CHURRO

(furious)

This is unbearable! We have to
find that radio and smash it!

MUFFIN

(whining)

My head hurts! Make it stop,
Churro!

Unable to stand the racket, Churro and Muffin abandon
the gold bars and their van. They march angrily down
the dark tunnel, determined to find and SMASH the
offending radio. PiPi, hovering unseen, WINKs at
Tango.

TANGO

*(whispering,
satisfied)*

Distraction deployed! Bravo, your
turn!

While they are distracted, Bravo springs into action.
He activates a compact, HIGH-TECH GADGET on his wrist:
a GRAVITY GRABBER. With a WHOOSH, a shimmering,
invisible field extends from his hand. He aims it at
the gold bars in the van. Effortlessly and silently,
all the real gold BARS LIFT into the air and FLOAT
back into the secure, detached train wagon. Next,
Bravo quickly pulls out a small, almost invisible
HOLOGRAPHIC PROJECTOR. It's the same kind of tech the
bandits used for the wall. He quickly REPROGRAMS it
and places it in the back of the now-empty van. It
projects a PERFECT, SHIMMERING ILLUSION of a pile of
gold bars, identical to the real ones. He quickly
closes the van doors. A SMASHING SOUND echoes from
further down the tunnel, followed by a relieved
SILENCE. Churro and Muffin return, rubbing their ears.

CHURRO

*(huffing, still
annoyed)*

Finally! That noise was giving me a headache! Now, let's get out of here.

MUFFIN

*(nodding vigorously,
unaware)*

Yeah! With all our precious, shiny gold! Percy will be so proud!

CHURRO

(smug)

They'll never know we were even here. Flawless execution!

They open the van, see the shimmering "gold," and quickly slam the doors shut, completely unaware of the trick. They jump into the van. Tires SCREECH as the heavily armored van speeds off into the tunnel. The camera pans to show Tango and Bravo high-fiving on top of the train wagon, PiPi doing a celebratory spin. The real, safely recovered gold is right beneath them. The clock hits 9:00.

SCENE 08 INT. VILLAIN'S LAIR - NIGHT (RESOLUTION - 9:00 - 10:00)

The villain's lair is dark, cavernous, and messy. PERCY, a short, portly man with a twitching mustache, paces impatiently.

PERCY

*(muttering to
himself)*

Where are those buffoons? The gold should be here by now!

Churro and Muffin drive their van into the lair, stopping with a flourish. They hop out, chests puffed with pride.

CHURRO

*(saluting Percy
proudly)*

Mission accomplished, Boss! The gold is ours!

MUFFIN

(grinning widely)

Yeah! We even got rid of those annoying Widgeteers! Hah!

PERCY

(eagerly)

Excellent! Open the doors! Let me see my precious gold!

Percy's eyes gleam with greedy anticipation. He marches to the back of the van. Churro dramatically SWINGS open the doors, revealing the shimmering pile of "gold."

CHURRO

(beaming)

Feast your eyes, Boss! A shimmering mountain of it!

MUFFIN

(proudly)

And we did it all ourselves! Well, mostly Churro.

Percy lets out a triumphant CHUCKLE. He reaches out a plump hand, his fingers wiggling, ready to grab the closest gold bar and admire his new wealth. His hand phases RIGHT THROUGH the illusion and SLAMS HARD into the EMPTY METAL FLOOR of the van. The holographic projector, jostled by the impact, FLICKERS and DIES. The "gold" VANISHES.

PERCY

*(stuttering,
disbelieving)*

My... my gold? It's... it's gone!

CHURRO

*(confused, poking
the empty floor)*

But... but it was just there! We saw it!

MUFFIN

*(frowning, looking
at his hands)*

Did I accidentally eat it? I
thought I just had cake.

PERCY

(spitting mad)

This isn't cake! This is an empty
van! You fools!

CHURRO

(suddenly realizing)

The Widgeteers! It must have been
them!

Percy's eyes narrow into furious slits. His face
contorts into a mask of pure, helpless RAGE. He
clenches his fists, shaking with fury. He tilts his
head back and lets out a primal SCREAM that echoes
through the lair.

PERCY

*(roaring, veins
popping)*

WIDGETEEEEEEERS!

Churro and Muffin flinch, shrinking back as Percy
continues his impotent rage. PiPi's cheeky BEEP is
heard from off-screen.